

# ZIXIN WANG

Ph.D. Candidate, London School of Economics and Political Science

The London School of Economics and Political Science  
Department of Economics  
Sir Arthur Lewis Building, Room 4.08  
London WC2A 3PH  
United Kingdom

[z.wang111@lse.ac.uk](mailto:z.wang111@lse.ac.uk)

Born 5 December 1997 (28 years old)  
Chinese Citizen

## EDUCATION

---

|                                                                                                                                                                               |                      |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------|
| <b>Ph.D. in Economics</b> , London School of Economics (LSE)<br>Fields: Political Economy, Economic History                                                                   | 2022–2027 (expected) |
| <b>M.Res. in Economics</b> (Merit), LSE                                                                                                                                       | 2020–2022            |
| <b>M.Sc. in Econometrics and Mathematical Economics</b> (Distinction), LSE                                                                                                    | 2019–2020            |
| <b>B.Sc. in Financial Mathematics</b> (First Class Honours), University of Liverpool<br>(2+2 joint programme: first two years at Xi'an Jiaotong-Liverpool University, Suzhou) | 2015–2019            |

## REFERENCES

---

**Ronny Razin**  
Professor, LSE  
[r.razin@lse.ac.uk](mailto:r.razin@lse.ac.uk)

**Kent Deng**  
Professor, LSE  
[k.g.deng@lse.ac.uk](mailto:k.g.deng@lse.ac.uk)

**Hao Chen**  
Assistant Professor,  
University of Twente  
[h.chen-3@utwente.nl](mailto:h.chen-3@utwente.nl)

## JOB MARKET PAPER

---

### “When Trade Distortions Disappear: Trade Reallocation and Social Conflict in Qing China”

**Abstract:** Trade distortions can sustain economic activity in the places that benefit from them, raising the question of what happens when they are removed. I study the 1842 Treaty of Nanjing, which ended the Canton System, a restriction that had concentrated China’s foreign trade in a single port for nearly a century. The new treaty ports let trade shift to lower-cost routes, sharply reducing traffic along the old inland routes to Canton. Using an original county-year panel of 427 counties from 1820 to 1860, I find that counties along the pre-1842 routes experienced a large rise in rebellion after the treaty, while the hinterlands of the new ports show no comparable increase. This asymmetry, concentrated in transithub counties, points to an opportunity cost channel through displaced transport workers rather than rapacity. Affected counties became substantially more susceptible to Taiping mobilization after 1851, linking the trade shock to one of the deadliest civil conflicts in history.

## WORKING PAPERS

---

- “Operational AI Embedding and Green Innovation: When Rapid Adaptation Matters”  
With Wei Zhao, Mahak Sharma, and Hao Chen

Submitted to *Technovation*

We introduce disclosed AI-enabled execution capability (AEC), a text-based measure of whether firms embed AI in operational and governance workflows rather than merely report its use. Using a panel of Chinese A-share listed firms (2020–2025), we find that the within-firm link between AEC and subsequent green invention patenting is small on average but substantially stronger when operating conditions demand rapid adaptation.

- **“Physics-Informed Modeling of Salinity-Gradient Power Generation and Operating Conditions”**

With Wei Zhao and Hao Chen

Submitted to *Renewable Energy*

We develop a physics-informed model of salinity-gradient power that represents the feed and draw channels separately and couples them through membrane transport. Validated against finite-element simulations, it reproduces the pressure-dependent power maximum and predicts a full field in a fraction of a second, enabling rapid screening of operating conditions before high-fidelity simulation.

## SEMINAR AND CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

---

**2026:** The 9th Asian Historical Economics Conference (upcoming, NUS), The 12th Symposium on Quantitative History (Wuhan, China), Warwick–LSE Political Economy Conference, Chinese Economy Research Group, LSE PSPE WIP Seminar, LSE Speech Seminar

## AWARDS AND RESEARCH GRANTS

---

STICERD Research Grant (No. 109824), London School of Economics £5,000, 2023

“Selection or Shaping? Cohort Effects, Experience, and Politicians’ Support for Military Intervention” (with Giorgio Ravalli and Peter Ward-Griffin)

LSE Economics Teaching Bonus Award 2023, 2024, 2026

## TEACHING EXPERIENCE

---

Graduate Teaching Assistant, LSE

- EC1A3: Microeconomics I (B.Sc.) 2022–2026
- EC1B3: Macroeconomics I (B.Sc.) 2022–2026

## PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

---

Macro Intern, Founder Securities Co. Feb 2021–Aug 2021

Research Assistant, Bank of China (Shanghai Branch) Sep 2020–Dec 2020

## COMPUTER SKILLS

---

Programming: MATLAB, Python, Stata, R

GIS: ArcGIS (QGIS)

Typographic: L<sup>A</sup>T<sub>E</sub>X

## LANGUAGES

---

Mandarin Chinese (native), English (fluent)

Last update: October 2026